

Lesson 1.2: Planning Community Interviews

Location: Classroom

Grade Level: High School

Time: 50 minutes

Driving Question

- How do different community members have different values and perspectives on climate change affecting the ocean?

Lesson Synopsis

In this 50-minute lesson, student teams get ready to explore community perspectives on the ocean by planning interviews with people that they know. These interviews will later serve as the foundation for students to build a model that shows how climate change affects the ocean and human communities.

Students begin by reflecting on how social scientists use interviews to understand community perspectives. After identifying the purpose of their interviews, they work in small teams to select questions from a question bank and plan their approach. To prepare, they watch a teacher-facilitated demonstration of ineffective interview techniques and discuss strategies for conducting successful interviews. By the end of the lesson, students will be ready to engage with community members and gather meaningful insights.

What Students Will Figure Out:

- Climate change impacts both natural and human systems, recognizing the importance of community perspectives in understanding these changes.
- We can develop practical skills in conducting interviews, understanding the role of social scientists, and selecting effective questions to gather meaningful data.
- Understanding that different communities have unique experiences and perspectives on environmental change can shape how we respond to it.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this investigation, students will be able to...	You can assess this using...
1. Describe how social scientists use interviews to gather qualitative data on community perspectives.	Class discussion during the <i>Navigate</i> section.
2. Select appropriate questions and plan an interview to understand how people connect with the ocean.	Student interview plans created during the <i>Investigate</i> section.
3. Identify and analyze effective and ineffective interviewing strategies	Class discussion during the <i>Navigate</i> section.

Building towards NGSS and AI Literacy:

- **HS-ESS2-4:** Changes in the atmosphere due to human activity have increased carbon dioxide concentrations and thus affect the climate.
- **HS-ESS3-1:** Construct an explanation based on evidence for how the availability of natural resources, occurrence of natural hazards, and climate change have influenced human activity.

LESSON OVERVIEW

Section	Time	What Happens
Navigate	5 minutes	Students discuss why interviews might be a helpful tool to help us understand our community's perspectives around how Orange County's ocean is changing.
Investigate	25 minutes	Students work in small teams to plan the logistics of their interviews, including identifying whom they will interview and selecting questions that will help meet their goals.
Navigate	10 minutes	Student teams briefly share their plan with another team for feedback.
Navigate	15 minutes	The teacher tests out one interview protocol, deliberately demonstrating bad interview habits. After watching the demonstration, the whole class brainstorms best practices for conducting interviews.
Problematize	5 minutes	Student teams revisit their plan one last time and identify any last questions they have before conducting their interview outside of class hours.

MATERIALS

- [Lesson 1.2 Slideshow](#)
- [Science Journal](#)
- A screen to view the slideshow with audio (projector, Promethean, etc.)

SUPPLIES

- (1) Science journal per student
- (1) Blank sheet of paper for interview questions (optional).

BEFORE YOU START TEACHING

1. Make a copy of the slideshow and make any appropriate changes for your class.
2. Make sure that you have a way to project a video with sound if you watch the interview etiquette videos.
3. The science journal is intended to be a digital notebook. However, if you decide to print copies for students, they may need a writing instrument (pen, pencil, etc.).
4. Optionally, you may want to provide a blank sheet of paper for students so they can easily reference their interview questions when they meet their interviewees.

WHERE WE ARE GOING AND NOT GOING

Where We Are Going: This lesson begins the data-gathering portion of the module. It introduces proper interview practices and invites students to draft interview questions to gain information about the values that their communities attach to the ocean. As the second lesson in the module, the goal is to familiarize students with qualitative interview techniques, similar to how social scientists would conduct investigations.

Some DCIs students will be thinking about include:

- **HS-ESS2-4:** Changes in the atmosphere due to human activity have increased carbon dioxide concentrations and thus affect the climate.
- **HS-ESS3-1:** Construct an explanation based on evidence for how the availability of natural resources, occurrence of natural hazards, and climate changes have influenced human activity.

Students will encounter the terms: community perspectives, interview etiquette, bias (in drafting interview questions). They will continue to think about climate change, global warming, weather, and climate change's positive and negative impact (e.g., on recreation, health and wellbeing, food sources, economy, etc.).

Where We Are NOT Going: The lesson focuses on the local impact of climate change. Students may bring some relevant cultural and personal experiences that may support them in creating the interview protocols. We will not fully investigate the global impacts of climate change.

LEARNING SEQUENCE

[Lesson plan notes are also on the slide notes.](#)

NAVIGATE**Navigate: How is Southern California's ocean changing? (25 minutes)**

1. Open the slideshow to **Slide 1** and welcome the class for the day. Tell them that today, their goal is to continue their investigations to learn how Southern California's ocean is being impacted by climate change.
2. Advance to **Slide 2** and invite students to discuss what they did in lesson 1.1. Use the following questions to help guide the conversation.
 - What did you learn about how climate change might be affecting Southern California's ocean?
 - How does climate change affect your experiences at the ocean?
 - What differences did you notice between using a search engine and generative AI?
 - What are the pros and cons of each method?
3. Advance to **Slide 3** and give students the overview for the module.
4. Advance to **Slide 4** and tell students that another way to gather information is through conducting interviews. Inform them that they will use interviews to find out more about why our community cares about the ocean and what they know about climate change.
5. To begin thinking about interviews, have students discuss the following questions with their team.
 - What is an interview? What experience do you have with them?
 - Why do we use interviews? What can they help us learn?
 - Who might interview someone as part of their job?
 - When and where do interviews take place?
6. If time allows, join the class together for a group discussion and tell students during lesson 1.2, they will step into the shoes of a social scientist and interview people to learn more about how the community feels about the impact of climate change on Southern California's ocean.
7. Wrap up activity and transition to the question of the day on **Slide 5**:
 - How can interviews help us understand our community's perspectives around how Southern California's ocean is changing?Give students 1-2 minutes to discuss in small groups and then ask for volunteers to share.

INVESTIGATE**Investigate: Interview Planning (25 minutes)**

1. Tell students that their next goal is to interview someone to help them understand the community's perspective around how Southern California's ocean is changing.
2. Advance to **Slide 6** and inform students that their first task in planning for their interview is to determine who they may want to interview. Tell students that the slide shares examples of individuals they may interview and give them a moment to identify someone to interview.
3. Advance the slideshow to **Slide 7** and inform them that just like social scientists plan their interviews, they will have to do so as well. When they plan their interviews, they will have to think about creating an interview protocol, which answers the following questions:
 - Who will you be interviewing?
 - What questions will you ask your interviewee?
 - What roles will each team member play?
4. To help students think about what types of questions they might want to ask, advance to **Slide 8** to display a question bank of potential questions. Tell students to prepare 3-4 questions to get them started and add them to on **Module 1.2: Planning Community Interviews (Student Task: Interview Planning), page 3** of their **Science Journals**. If they would like, they could create their own questions.
5. While students work, walk around the room to check in on each group or provide support when needed. During this time, make note of a few interview plans to showcase in the *Expand* activity, where they will work on the Lesson 1.2 Interview Etiquette Worksheet, which starts on **Module 1.2 Part 1: Planning Community Interviews (Student Task: Interview Etiquette), page 4-5** in the **Science Journal**.

NAVIGATE**Navigate: Refining Interview Plans (10 minutes)**

1. Once teams have created their interview plan, bring the whole class back together. Tell them that their next step is to work with another team to refine their interview plan.

2. Once student teams are paired together, advance to **Slide 9**. Have student teams share their plan with each other and then refine their plans using the feedback they receive. Below are questions that can help guide the conversation:
 - Are the interview questions clear and specific?
 - Do they make sense? Would the interviewee understand what's being asked?
 - Do the questions encourage a detailed answer rather than a simple "yes" or "no"?
 - Are the interview questions relevant and connected to climate change and the ocean?
 - Are the interview questions unbiased and neutral?
 - Do they allow for honest responses without leading the interviewee?
 - Are the interview questions engaging, and do they invite personal stories, experiences, or expert knowledge?
3. As students are talking with each other, walk around and provide support where students have questions. If time allows, get the group back together and have a group share their interview plan.

NAVIGATE

Navigate: Interview Etiquette (15 minutes)

1. Tell students that another area that social scientists focus on before and during their interview is their interview etiquette, or a guide on how to behave in a social setting like an interview.
2. To identify the best practices in interview etiquette, tell students that they will observe what makes an interview effective or ineffective and why. The educator can pick from one of the following options:
 - Activity Option 1: Lesson 1.2 Interview Etiquette Worksheet
 - Advance to **Slide 10** and ask students to find the [interview etiquette page in their science journals \(p. 4-5\)](#).
 - With their teams, have students go through the three excerpts and state why the situation demonstrates proper interview etiquette.
 - What are examples of effective vs ineffective interview etiquette?
 - If it is not effective, what can be improved?
 - Once students are done, bring the class together to discuss and come up with a list of ideal mannerisms for their interviews.
 - Activity Option 2: Interview Videos

- Advance to **Slide 11**, where there are two videos. One video portrays effective interview etiquette, and the other video portrays ineffective interview etiquette.
 - As students watch the interviews, have them note down their observations.
 - Once both videos have been watched, bring the class back together to discuss.
 - What are some similarities and differences between the videos?
 - What are examples of effective and ineffective interview etiquette?
3. Bring the class together after the activity and share that they will create a list containing qualities of a good interview.
 4. Advance to **Slide 12**, which asks the class to build a list containing the qualities of good interview etiquette. As students answer, fill in the list on the slideshow.

PROBLEMATIZE

Problematize (5 minutes)

1. Advance to **Slide 13**. If time allows, give students a couple of extra minutes to make further revisions to their interview plan after learning more about interview etiquette. Make sure to remind students to ask interviewees if it is ok to take notes and audio record the interview. Students may use **Module 1.2 Part 2: Conducting Community Interviews (Student Task: Optional Interview Notes)** in the Science Journal (p. 7) as space to type their questions and responses from interviews (*Notes will be used for the next analysis in Lesson 1.3.*)
2. Advance to **Slide 14**. As students wrap up, give them time to reflect back on their experiences during lesson 1.2 on **Module 1.2 Part 1: Planning your Community Interviews (Student Reflection) (p. 6)** of their **Science Journal**.
 - What did you learn about planning and preparing for your community interview? How has your thinking about asking questions or gathering information changed?
 - What do you hope to learn from your community interview?
 - What questions do you still have before conducting your interview? How could you find answers or prepare?

3. Advance to **Slide 15** and thank the students for their time. Allow students to ask any questions they may have before they conduct their interviews. In the next lesson, students will analyze the results of their interview.